

Bryan Gator Stephens

Operations Leader | AI Workflow Specialist | Contact Center Management

bgstephens0@gmail.com • (606) 305-4393 • Phoenix, AZ | Open to Remote

[LinkedIn](#) • [GitHub](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Self-taught AI builder and operations leader with 6+ years managing large-scale scheduling teams in the solar energy industry. Designs and deploys real AI-powered automation tools, not proof-of-concepts, but working systems in active production use, using Claude and ChatGPT to replace manual workflows, eliminate errors, and free teams to do higher-value work. Brings a rare combination of operational depth and genuine AI fluency that most candidates claim but few can demonstrate.

Promoted from local scheduler to centralized Scheduling Supervisor in under 8 months, then built and ran a department of up to 35 coordinators managing 1,300+ daily calls at peak and scheduling 200+ residential solar installs nationwide at peak. Bridges the gap between human teams and AI-enabled systems through servant leadership, operational discipline, and forward-thinking technology adoption.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| ◆ AI Workflow Automation | ◆ Prompt Engineering | ◆ Agentic Tool Design |
| ◆ Team Leadership & Development | ◆ Contact Center Management | ◆ Process Improvement & Optimization |
| ◆ Recruiting, Onboarding & Retention | ◆ Partner Relationship Management | ◆ Operational Metrics & Reporting |
| ◆ Scheduling & Capacity Planning | ◆ SLA Management | ◆ Servant Leadership |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Scheduling Supervisor | Freedom Forever

Jan 2021 – Present

Customer Operations | Centralized Scheduling Hub, Las Vegas, NV | Reports to: Ty Trippany, Director of Customer Operations

AI Automation & Technology

- Designed and deployed three production AI automation tools using Claude and ChatGPT, each operating as an autonomous agent that replaces a manual, error-prone workflow with a fully automated system. Combined estimated annualized labor savings: \$55,000+.
- Partner Portal Automation: monitors the scheduling calendar, detects visits requiring third-party updates, navigates directly into partner portals (Sunrun, Goodleap), and updates notes and fields in real time. Handles an estimated 75-100 updates/day; estimated labor savings of \$50,000+/year, plus elimination of partner SLA errors that carried relationship risk with key financiers.
- Calendar Cleanup Automation: scans for visits flagged for removal, deletes them from the calendar system, and automatically sends customer notification emails. Fully replaced a manual, coordinator-driven cancellation process; estimated labor savings of \$6,000+/year.
- Scheduling Team Dashboard: built to serve dual audiences — executive leadership tracking KPIs and scheduling metrics at a glance, and frontline coordinators following plain-language protocols written for entry-level comprehension. Adopted department-wide as the authoritative operational reference.

- Served as the primary operational voice in the development of Freedom Forever's proprietary auto-scheduling tool, translating real-world scheduling logic into product requirements for the development team.

Contact Center Operations & Volume Management

- Oversaw daily contact center operations managing 500–600 inbound customer calls and 500–600 outbound scheduling calls per day, maintaining SLAs while balancing throughput and backlog simultaneously.
- Managed multiple contact center queues at once, ensuring staffing coverage, handling escalations, and driving consistent SLA attainment across a high-volume, fast-moving environment.
- Coordinated scheduling for install crews and surveyors across the U.S., peaking at 200+ residential solar installations scheduled per period from the centralized Las Vegas hub.

Team Leadership & Department Building

- Built the centralized scheduling department from the ground up, establishing the team culture, standards, workflows, and accountability systems that allow it to operate reliably at scale.
- Managed a fluctuating team of 16 to 35 scheduling coordinators, scaling headcount based on install volume while maintaining performance standards and team cohesion.
- Managed the full talent lifecycle: recruiting, interviewing, onboarding, training, performance management, and developing coordinators into high performers.
- Set the cultural tone for the department, built a team identity rooted in ownership, accountability, and continuous improvement rather than just task completion.

Cross-functional & Partner Collaboration

- Maintained strong working relationships with key external partners, Sunrun and Goodleap, through reliable, automated portal communication that eliminated manual follow-up.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with install operations, finance, and product teams to align scheduling capacity with broader company goals and partner SLA expectations.
- Consistently identified systemic inefficiencies outside the scheduling team's direct scope and drove fixes that benefited multiple departments, a pattern recognized at the leadership level.

RECOGNITION: "Sky is the Limit" Award, Freedom Forever (2023). Awarded for leadership and innovation that elevated the entire scheduling department and extended well beyond the scope of the role.

Local Scheduler | Phoenix Branch | Freedom Forever

May 2020 – Jan 2021

Customer Operations | Phoenix, AZ | Individual Contributor

- Managed all local install and survey scheduling for the Phoenix branch independently, sole scheduler for the market.
- Demonstrated the operational instincts and initiative that led to a promotion to Scheduling Supervisor in under 8 months, ahead of the company's centralization of scheduling to Las Vegas.
- Built end-to-end scheduling workflow knowledge that directly informed the design of the centralized department.

Assistant Manager | Men's Wearhouse

March 2019 – March 2020

Retail Operations | High-Volume Store Environment

- Supervised daily floor operations and a team of retail associates in a high-volume, customer-facing environment, building direct leadership instincts that have since scaled to managing teams many times larger.
- Drove consistent achievement of store sales targets through associate coaching, floor scheduling, and building a customer-first team culture.

- Managed associate performance and scheduling while maintaining operational standards across all store departments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

AI Platforms	Claude (Anthropic) [primary], ChatGPT (OpenAI)
AI Specializations	Prompt Engineering, Agentic Workflow Design, Browser Automation, Portal Automation, Process Optimization
Phone Systems	Vonage, Dialpad, RingCentral
Project & Ops Tools	Atlassian Jira, Lightspeed, Microsoft Teams, Outlook
Data & Reporting	MySQL, Dashboard design, KPI tracking, Operational reporting
Scheduling Systems	Scheduling portal management, Calendar administration, SLA monitoring

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

"Sky is the Limit" Award | Freedom Forever (2023)

Awarded for leadership and innovation that elevated the entire scheduling department, specifically for building AI-powered tools and driving process improvements that benefited the team, the company, and its external partners.

Promotion: Local Scheduler → Centralized Scheduling Supervisor | Freedom Forever (2021)

Promoted in under 8 months from individual contributor to leading the newly centralized scheduling department in Las Vegas, reflecting exceptional performance and the direct trust of senior leadership.

EDUCATION

Northern Arizona University | Psychology | Attended 2014 – 2018

Flagstaff, AZ